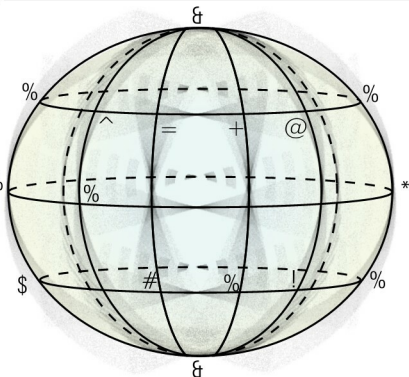




‘Good’ Coding Practices

Here are some dos and don'ts while coding in C.

Following some sound logic is not always sufficient for developers working with C language to write good code.

There are some tacit assumptions when good programmers write programs. They typically make the code more reliable, portable, less error-prone and, most importantly, make it more readable. These standards vary depending on the project type, deployment scenario, compiler support, footprint limit, etc.

As far as the automotive industry is concerned, there exists an industry-wide solution called Misra C standards, which contains a set of 141 rules that should be

followed when a piece of C code is written. (Read more about this at en.wikipedia.org/wiki/MISRA_C.)

These coding conventions are really good habits to follow, and they distinguish an amateur C programmer from a professional. In this article, we will try to understand such coding guidelines. The reference compiler here is GCC, but the guidelines are more or less the same for most of the other compilers.

General practices

Most projects have project specific guidelines regarding the variable naming and file naming conventions. The base